CSS Multi-column Layout

fulgur routes CSS multicol containers through a custom Taffy layout hook. Taffy sees the balanced column height as the container's intrinsic size, so surrounding siblings flow naturally around it — no post-pass reshape, no sibling overlap.

Two columns, four paragraphs

Alpha paragraph. Each child block is measured at the column width and then packed into balanced columns.

Beta paragraph. The balance algorithm searches for the smallest per-column budget that fits all children without overflow.

Gamma paragraph. When the multicol grows or shrinks relative to Taffy's initial pass, siblings after it are shifted to match.

Delta paragraph. Two-column layout is the canonical case for this hook design.

Three columns

First column entry. Second column entry, slightly longer so it exercises the balance budget search.

Third column entry. Fourth paragraph. Fifth paragraph in the mix. Sixth paragraph to fill out the third column.

After the multicol

Because the hook updates Taffy's layout directly, this paragraph sits at the correct y — directly below the balanced multicol container, not overlapping with its columns.

Column rule

First column content with a visible rule on the right.

Second column content. The rule appears in the gap.

Column span: all

Before the spanning element.

Also before the spanning element.

This heading spans all columns

After the spanning element, layout resumes in two columns.

Second paragraph after the span.